“I’ll bring her to the tent to clean it now, see how deep the cut is and whether I’ll need to operate. Can you and Olga bring the others from the wagon?”

Léa wanted to ask the soldiers to help, but they’d already retreated to the tent, distancing themselves from the sick women. “Yes.” Léa turned back to the wagon. “Nadiya,” she called.

“*Da*?” A young woman’s voice rose up, and she waved her arm in the air.

Léa went to her. “Can you stand?” She bent down, circling an arm around Nadiya’s shoulders. “I’ll help you.” Léa lifted her up, supporting her to the door and out onto the platform. Nadiya blinked in the stark daylight, her hand on the small bump under her coat. “Olga, ask if she has any bleeding.”

“She says she bled, but it stopped a few days ago. She’s afraid for the baby.”

“Tell her it’s a good sign that the bleeding stopped. I will give her some medicine to help.” Léa thought of the two boxes of Betabion back at the sick bay. She turned to Olga. “Help her to the tent, give her some water. Then come back to assist with the others.”

Léa returned to the wagon. “Who’s next?”

The women responded, each pointing to the person they thought was the most needy. All were unsteady on their feet. She’d seen that they’d been given some food, as eggshells littered the ground and she guessed the women had had just enough to survive. She made her way to each one, offering reassurance until the wagon was empty, except for the woman who had died during the journey. Then she began to unload the other wagon.

It was late afternoon by the time all the women were in the tent, and Josef had made a preliminary assessment. Léa counted nineteen women, and had Olga deliver a note to Lagerführer Klein to request someone take care of the dead woman on the train. Though the women were bony, dehydrated, malnourished and still in shock, Josef was confident that after a few weeks in the sick bay, with good care, food and rest, they would all recover.

“But will they be given a few weeks?” Léa asked.

“Probably not. But we will suggest it in my report.”

“How is Anna’s hand?”